Aiyar (and A. Sundara Sastri), Guruswami Aiyar personally felt the heat. Wynch ordered them to either oust VOC from the company or, if not, at least pack him off for some months somewhere away from Tuticorin.[45]

K.R. Guruswami Aiyar loyally carried out his orders. VOC was 'sent for'. In no uncertain terms, he was 'told that the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company, in whose employ he was, would not tolerate any more speeches on his part'.[46] Rather than be restrained by the administration or the company, he was 'gently' advised that it would be better if he left gracefully—go to Bombay or some other place on company business. Pressure was brought through Guruswami Aiyar's brother, K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar—who had VOC's trust—to repair to Bombay immediately.[47] Though it was rumoured that this message had come from Wynch, Guruswami Aiyar claimed shamelessly that it was of their own volition. Initially, VOC agreed. But he returned a few minutes later and retracted his consent. When this issue was discussed a month later, at an audience with the governor-in-council, to a pointed question from the chief secretary, if 'Mr Chidambaram Pillai refused to be coerced by the directors', Guruswami Aiyar replied: 'He refused to accept our advice.'[48] By then it was late evening. The directors reiterated their demand the next morning, on 8 March. If the company was to initiate any action unilaterally against him, VOC retorted that he would resign. This was precisely what the management wanted. The offer was gladly accepted. N.A.V. Somasundaram Pillai and A. Sundara Sastri quickly drafted a letter of resignation. VOC agreed to sign it, but within minutes he decided otherwise. This about-turn was immediately communicated to Wynch, who remained camped outside. An impatient collector told the directors that he could not wait interminably for VOC's ouster.[49] (VOC's defiance notwithstanding, the directors' resolution instructing him not to involve in any political activity was copied to Wynch to reassure the collector that they were carrying out his wish.)

In refusing to be cowed down despite the enormous pressure, VOC had consulted Subramania Siva and Gurunathaiyar, both of whom categorically